

DIPLOMATIC WORKING DOCUMENT

Stability First Accord

*A Simplified, Modular Framework for US-Iran Stabilization,
Strait of Hormuz Governance, and Nuclear Resolution*

Version 1.0 | May 2026

Calibrated for the Current Diplomatic Window

Drawing from: Hormuz First Enhanced Accord v2.0

RCSA Simplified Edition 2026 | RCSA v3.6 Final Diplomatic Edition

Modular Hormuz Solutions Annex v1.0 | Modular Nuclear Solutions Annex 1.0

Table of Contents

Preamble: The May 2026 Moment

Section 1: Eight Core Principles

Section 2: Framework Overview

2.1 The Three Stages at a Glance

2.2 Synchronized Reciprocal Motion

2.3 Modular Design

Section 3: Stage One - The Opening (Days 1-14)

3.1 Day 1: Ceasefire and Stockpile Transfer

3.2 Day 3: Humanitarian Corridor Opens

3.3 Day 7: Synchronized Dual Blockade Lift

3.4 Day 14: Stage One Closing

Section 4: Stage Two - The Exchange (Days 15-60)

4.1 Nuclear Moratorium Architecture

4.2 Fordow Conversion

4.3 Sanctions Relief and Asset Return

Section 5: Stage Three - Permanent Architecture (Days 61-180)

5.1 The International Hormuz Transit Authority

5.2 Regional Security Dialogue

5.3 Full Normalization Path

Section 6: Modular Hormuz Solutions

6.1 Governance Pathways

6.2 Security Pathways

6.3 Economic Pathways

Section 7: Modular Nuclear Solutions

7.1 Stockpile Disposition Options

7.2 Facility Transformation Options

7.3 Verification Choices

Section 8: Five-Channel Verification

Section 9: What Each Side Wins

Section 10: Safeguards and Protections

Section 11: Crisis Management

Section 12: Implementation Roadmap

Section 13: The Stabilization Arsenal (25 Mechanisms)

Section 14: Advanced Structural Hardening (15 Mechanisms)

Appendices

A. Sequencing Matrix Quick Reference

B. Diplomatic Framing Guide

C. Glossary of Terms

D. Deadlock Bypass Matrix

Preamble: The May 2026 Moment

As of May 2026, the United States and the Islamic Republic of Iran stand at the closest point to a durable agreement since hostilities began on February 28, 2026. Both governments are reviewing a one-page Memorandum of Understanding that would end the war and open a 30-day negotiating window. This document, the **Stability First Accord**, is designed to fill that window with a complete, ready-to-implement architecture.

Why This Moment Is Different

- **US gasoline prices** have reached \$4.53 per gallon nationally (\$6+ in California), creating domestic urgency for resolution.
- **Project Freedom** (the US Navy Hormuz escort operation, launched May 4) was paused on May 6, signaling a shift from military to diplomatic pressure.
- **Iran** has conditionally indicated willingness to transfer its highly enriched uranium stockpile out of the country -- a position it rejected as recently as April 2026.
- **Both sides** have implicitly accepted Pakistan as primary mediator and acknowledge the dual blockade cannot continue.
- **The approaching Hajj pilgrimage** (~May 25) creates a hard deadline where escalation carries severe political costs.
- **A 40-nation European coalition** (led by France's Charles de Gaulle carrier) is forming, providing multilateral legitimacy for joint Hormuz governance.

The current negotiations have converged toward a 12-15 year enrichment moratorium as the compromise between Iran's 5-year offer and the US 20-year demand. On Hormuz, both sides accept reopening but differ on governance. On assets, both accept return but differ on sequencing. These gaps are bridgeable -- but only with a detailed, modular architecture that neither side can claim as capitulation.

What This Document Is

The Stability First Accord is a **simplified, modular diplomatic instrument** drawn from five comprehensive source documents:

Table 1 *Source Document Integration*

SOURCE DOCUMENT	WHAT IT CONTRIBUTES
Hormuz First Enhanced Accord v2.0	Three-stage timeline, synchronized blockade lift, IHTA architecture
RCSA Simplified Edition 2026	Modular track system, sovereignty preservation, economic ladder
RCSA v3.6 Final Diplomatic Edition	Verification architecture, risk appetite framework, guarantor model
Modular Hormuz Solutions Annex v1.0	100 pathways for Hormuz governance, security, and economics
Modular Nuclear Solutions Annex 1.0	100 pathways for stockpile disposition and facility conversion

What This Document Is Not

This is not a comprehensive peace treaty. It does not resolve the ballistic missile question, Lebanon final status, Yemen reconstruction, Iraqi militia integration, or the Israeli-Palestinian question. Those matters are reserved for successor frameworks. This Accord creates the stable platform upon which those harder questions can be addressed.

How to Read This Document

Negotiators should read Section 1 (Principles), Section 2 (Overview), and Section 9 (What Each Side Wins) first. Technical specialists should then focus on their domain: Hormuz (Sections 3, 6), Nuclear (Sections 4, 7), Verification (Section 8), or Crisis Management (Section 11). The Appendices provide quick-reference tools for use during active negotiation.

Section 1: Eight Core Principles

Every provision in this Accord is governed by eight foundational principles. These are not aspirational language -- they are the structural rules that ensure the agreement survives implementation.

Principle 1: Synchronized Reciprocal Motion

Neither side moves alone. Every Iranian commitment is matched by a corresponding US commitment on the same day or the next sequential day. Every US commitment is matched by a corresponding Iranian commitment. Verification is shared. This is not mere political optics -- it is structural. Both governments can credibly claim the other moved first or simultaneously.

Principle 2: Modular Architecture

The Accord operates through independent modules. Failure in one module does not collapse the others. If nuclear verification encounters a dispute, Hormuz transit continues. If sanctions relief faces a delay, the ceasefire holds. This prevents the total-collapse failure mode that destroyed the JCPOA.

Principle 3: Sovereignty Preservation

This framework does not supersede any constitution. It does not create supranational authority. It does not impair sovereign defense rights. It does not force alliance realignment. Iran's NPT rights are preserved. US treaty commitments to Gulf partners are preserved. Both governments retain full constitutional authority.

Principle 4: Irreversible Facts on the Ground

Each stage produces physically irreversible deliverables. Once Iran's weapons-grade stockpile is transferred to IAEA custody in Oman, it cannot be silently returned. Once \$250 million in Iranian assets is transferred, it cannot be clawed back. Once Hormuz is reopened and the IHTA is operating, closure requires a deliberate political decision with visible consequences. These irreversible facts create constituencies for continuation.

Principle 5: Multiple Pathways for Every Major Issue

Rather than demanding a single solution, the Accord provides modular options for Hormuz governance, nuclear disposition, and verification intensity. Parties select the combination that fits their political constraints. The appendices contain selection guides for rapid decision-making.

Principle 6: Quiet Compliance

Minor violations are corrected confidentially through the Joint Implementation Group, not through public accusations. The framework distinguishes between technical discrepancies (corrected quietly) and material breaches (addressed formally). This protects domestic political space for both governments.

Principle 7: Neither Recognition Nor Surrender

Participation in this Accord does not constitute diplomatic recognition where none exists. It does not require either government to acknowledge defeat, capitulation, or unconditional surrender. Each government may characterize the outcome in terms that serve its domestic political requirements, provided objective benchmarks are met.

Principle 8: Succession Resilience

The Accord binds institutions, not individuals. Commitments attach to the Office of the President, the Department of State, the Supreme National Security Council, the Central Bank, and the Majlis. Changes of government activate continuity provisions rather than withdrawal procedures.

Section 2: Framework Overview

2.1 The Three Stages at a Glance

The Accord operates as three sequenced stages, each with defined entry conditions, obligations, verification standards, and transition triggers. The architecture is deliberately modular: failure at any stage does not collapse prior stages.

Table 2 *The Three-Stage Framework*

STAGE	DURATION	PRIMARY GOAL	CLOSING TRIGGER
Stage 1: The Opening	Days 1-14	End the war; transfer stockpile to IAEA custody; reopen Hormuz; lift both blockades	Both blockades lifted; 200+ vessel transits; IAEA custody verified
Stage 2: The Exchange	Days 15-60	Nuclear moratorium; Fordow conversion; sanctions relief; SWIFT reconnection	Nuclear exchange verified; 50% assets returned; SWIFT process begun
Stage 3: Permanent Architecture	Days 61-180	Permanent IHTA treaty; regional security dialogue; successor framework handoff	IHTA charter ratified; 85% assets returned; RCSA/Crescent Compact opened

2.2 Synchronized Reciprocal Motion

The sequencing follows what the source frameworks call the **Waltz Philosophy** of synchronized reciprocal motion. The principle is simple: each commitment by one party is matched by a corresponding commitment by the other; neither party is exposed to defection; verification is shared.

Example: Day 1 Synchronization

Iran moves: Transfers entire 60%-enriched uranium stockpile to IAEA custody in Oman; ceases all offensive operations; transmits Hezbollah operational pause instruction.

US moves (same day): Suspends Project Freedom; ceases all offensive operations; issues OFAC license for \$250 million pilot asset release.

Verification: Pakistani PM Office + UN Special Envoy + Omani technical channel + Swiss financial channel issue concurrent certification.

2.3 Modular Design

Six independent tracks advance at their own pace. Progress in one does not depend on progress in another:

Table 3 *Six Independent Implementation Tracks*

TRACK	INTRODUCED	GOVERNING BODY	INDEPENDENT ADVANCEMENT
Nuclear	Day 1	IAEA + Joint Implementation Group	Yes -- based on IAEA metrics
Maritime Security	Day 1	IHTA Council + Maritime Coordination Cell	Yes -- based on transit data
Economic/Sanctions	Day 7	JIG + Swiss Channel + OFAC	Yes -- based on financial compliance
Humanitarian	Day 1	UN OCHA + IHTA	Yes -- cannot be paused
Regional Security	Day 75	JIG + expanded membership	Requires core party consent
Reconstruction	Day 45	Iranian Reconstruction Fund + Civilian World Bank	Yes -- based on disbursement metrics

The Rule of Independent Tracks

While tracks advance independently, certain combinations unlock additional benefits:

- Nuclear Track stabilizes + Economic Track activates = SWIFT reconnection pathway opens
- Security Track and Humanitarian Track both advance = Regional Development Fund Stage 2 releases
- Any track may be paused for recalibration without affecting other tracks
- Humanitarian Track operates at full capacity at all times and cannot be paused

Section 3: Stage One -- The Opening (Days 1-14)

Stage One is the heart of the Accord. It runs for 14 days from signature and produces seven irreversible operational deliverables. By Day 14, the dual blockade is lifted, the Joint Hormuz Authority is operating in provisional mode, the war-fighting domain is closed, the first sovereign asset transfer is complete, and Iran's weapons-grade enriched uranium stockpile is under verified IAEA custody in a third country.

3.1 Day 1: Ceasefire and Stockpile Transfer

At 0000 GMT on Day 1, a permanent bilateral ceasefire takes effect on all US-Iran fronts. The following occur simultaneously:

Table 4 *Day 1 Deliverables*

PARTY	ACTION	VERIFICATION
Iran	Transfer entire 60%-enriched uranium stockpile to IAEA custody in Oman; cease all offensive operations; transmit Hezbollah operational pause instruction; transmit Houthi Red Sea pause instruction	IAEA Director-General confirmation; mass spectrometry; continuous CCTV and satellite monitoring
United States	Suspend Project Freedom; cease all offensive operations; issue OFAC general license for \$250M pilot asset transfer; confirm Sovereign Energy Partnership framing in writing	CENTCOM operational order; Pakistani guarantor confirmation; Iranian Central Bank confirms receipt

Why the \$250 Million Pilot Matters

The pilot asset transfer is unconditional and non-reversible. It is not a payment or reparations -- it is the return of Iranian sovereign property. It creates an immediate, visible Iranian win that generates domestic political space for the nuclear steps that follow. The pilot also creates a US interest in completion: once \$250 million has been transferred, the political cost of reversal for the US rises.

3.2 Day 3: Humanitarian Corridor Opens

On Day 3, the first humanitarian-flagged vessel transits the Strait of Hormuz under Joint Hormuz Authority observation. This is a zero-fee, no-inspection-delay transit for food, medicine, medical equipment, and UN supplies. The humanitarian corridor operates at all maturity levels and cannot be paused regardless of disputes in other tracks.

3.3 Day 7: Synchronized Dual Blockade Lift

The single most important mechanical element of Stage One is the synchronized lifting of the dual blockade on Day 7.

Step 1 (Day 1): Both governments issue identical written declarations to the Pakistani guarantor, Omani technical channel, and Swiss financial channel, committing to the synchronized lift on Day 7.

Step 2 (Days 1-6): The Joint Hormuz Authority's Maritime Coordination Cell in Muscat finalizes Day 7 operational protocols. Iran's transit-permit system transitions to JHA-coordinated electronic clearance. US Fifth Fleet establishes coordination links with Iranian Navy through the Omani-hosted hotline.

Step 3 (Day 7, 0000 GMT): Both lifts declared operative simultaneously. JHA observation vessels (US, Iranian, Omani flagged, with international observers) take station at Khasab and Bandar Abbas.

Step 4 (Day 7 +24h): First commercial vessel transits in each direction under JHA observation. Lloyd's List and UN OCHA confirm. JHA issues first daily transit report.

Step 5 (Day 7 +72h): If either lift is not verified by this point, the unlifted side's lift commitment is suspended. Matter referred to JHA emergency session and Pakistani guarantor. Default: maintain both blockades until synchronization is achieved.

3.4 Day 14: Stage One Closing

By Day 14, the following must be verified for Stage One to close:

- Both blockades lifted and verified (JHA observation vessels; Lloyd's List; UN OCHA; guarantor naval observers)

- At least 200 cumulative commercial vessel transits in the 14-day period
- IAEA confirms weapons-grade stockpile in secure custody in Oman
- Ceasefire intact with no verified offensive operations by either side
- JHA provisional mode confirmed with operational Maritime Coordination Cell
- First humanitarian corridor transits confirmed

Upon verification by Pakistan, Oman, and Switzerland concurrently, Stage One closes automatically and Stage Two begins.

US Commitments in Stage One

- Cease all offensive military operations against Iran, Iranian forces, and Iranian-linked installations
- Lift the naval blockade on Iranian commercial ports on Day 7 in synchronized motion
- Suspend Project Freedom unilateral escort operations on Day 1
- Issue OFAC general license for \$250M pilot asset transfer on Day 1
- Issue OFAC general license for humanitarian trade within 14 days (medicine, medical equipment, food, agricultural inputs)
- Pause all new sanctions designations for Stage One duration
- Confirm in writing that the nuclear exchange is a Sovereign Energy Partnership, not an imposed dismantlement

Iranian Commitments in Stage One

- Cease all offensive operations against US forces, US bases, and US-flagged or US-affiliated vessels
- Open the Strait of Hormuz beginning Day 3 (humanitarian) and Day 7 (full commercial), synchronized with US blockade lift
- Withdraw IRGC small craft from positions within 5 nautical miles of the central transit corridor
- Commence good-faith mine-clearing operations with JHA Maritime Safety Working Group
- Initiate stockpile transfer to IAEA custody on Day 1; maintain no enrichment above 3.67% from Day 1 forward
- Transmit to Houthi leadership an instruction to implement a Red Sea operational pause on commercial shipping

Section 4: Stage Two -- The Exchange (Days 15-60)

Stage Two converts the operational stabilization of Stage One into durable economic, institutional, and nuclear measures. By Day 60, half of Iran's frozen sovereign assets have been returned, the first sanctions tranche is operative, the IAEA has fully redeployed, and the comprehensive nuclear exchange is verified complete.

4.1 Nuclear Moratorium Architecture

The current MOU discussions include a moratorium on uranium enrichment of between 12 and 15 years, with Iran's 5-year offer and the US 20-year demand converging toward this range. This Accord adopts a 12-year moratorium with a violation-extension mechanism:

Table 5 Enrichment Moratorium Structure

PHASE	DURATION		ENRICHMENT STANDARD			CONDITION FOR ADVANCEMENT
Moratorium Phase	Years	1-12 (minimum; extendable)	Zero enrichment under IAEA seal.	3.67%. All higher-enrichment centrifuges	above	Clean IAEA certification at 12-year review; no material breach
Civilian Transition	Years	13-15	3.67% enrichment for civilian fuel-cycle purposes at Natanz only	enrichment for civilian fuel-cycle purposes	at Natanz only	Fuel supply guarantee deposited in escrow; Section 123 Agreement operative
Steady-State Civilian	Year	16 onwards	3.67% enrichment under full IAEA safeguards; Phase 3 architecture	enrichment under full IAEA safeguards; Phase 3 architecture	RCSA	five-year renewal confirmed; all compliance indicators at green

Automatic Extension Mechanism

Any material breach of enrichment limits triggers automatic moratorium extension of 2 years per breach. Extension is determined by Joint Implementation Group majority on the basis of IAEA technical reporting, not by unilateral US certification. This prevents the extension mechanism from becoming a tool for geopolitical pressure unrelated to actual nuclear behavior.

4.2 Fordow Conversion

By Day 60, Fordow is converted to a medical-isotope research center producing molybdenum-99, iodine-131, and xenon-133 for regional healthcare under international consortium management. The conversion proceeds through four stages:

- 1. **Phase A (Days 15-30):** Cessation of all enrichment activity; complete inventory; IAEA seals applied
- 2. **Phase B (Days 31-45):** Removal of uranium hexafluoride; down-blending to natural uranium or transfer to Natanz
- 3. **Phase C (Days 46-60):** Removal of enrichment-specific infrastructure; placement in IAEA-monitored storage
- 4. **Phase D (Month 4-18):** IMIRC activation -- international research partnership for medical isotope production under co-management

On Day 60, Iran hosts the inaugural International Medical Isotope Summit, signaling the transition from weapons-grade production to humanitarian medical research.

4.3 Sanctions Relief and Asset Return

Approximately \$100-120 billion in Iranian sovereign assets remains frozen across multiple jurisdictions. The Accord adopts a tranche structure:

Table 6 *Asset Return Tranche Architecture*

TRANCHE	TIMING	AMOUNT	TRIGGER	REVERSIBILITY
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Pilot	Day 1 (Stage 1)	\$250M		Signature		Non-reversible
Tranche 1	Day 30 (Stage 2)	25% minus pilot		Stage 1 closed; IAEA custody verified		Non-reversible
Tranche 2	Day 60 (Stage 2 close)	25%		60-day nuclear compliance; exchange verified		Non-reversible
Tranche 3	Day 120 (Stage 3)	20%		Permanent operational; IHTA Stage 3 dialogue opened		30-day remediation window
Tranche 4	Day 180 (Stage 3 close)	15%		180-day nuclear compliance; exchange maintained		Subject to JIG material-breach review
Reserve	Day 365	10%		12 months sustained compliance		Held pending material-breach determination
Balance	Year 2-3 (RCSA)	Remainder		Full RCSA Phase 2-3 compliance		RCSA risk appetite framework

The pilot and Tranches 1 and 2 are explicitly non-reversible upon transfer. This matches operational reality: Iran's Stage One nuclear and maritime concessions are physically irreversible once executed. The non-reversibility of the first 50 percent of asset return reflects the non-reversibility of Iran's Stage One concessions.

Sanctions Relief Sequencing

Table 7 *Sanctions Relief Sequencing*

TRANCHE	TIMING	SECTORS COVERED
Humanitarian	Day 1	Medicine, medical equipment, food, agricultural inputs, aviation safety parts
Tranche 1	Day 30	Aviation safety parts; consumer exports; specialty goods
Tranche 2	Day 60	Tier 1 banking authorization; OFAC mirror licensing

Tranche 3	Day 120	Petrochemicals; oil services; Tier 2 banking
Tranche 4	Day 180	Oil export normalization; insurance normalization

Section 5: Stage Three -- Permanent Architecture (Days 61-180)

Stage Three converts the provisional arrangements into permanent architecture and opens the broader regional dialogue. It is the bridge to the comprehensive successor framework.

5.1 The International Hormuz Transit Authority

On Day 90, the provisional Joint Hormuz Authority converts to the permanent **International Hormuz Transit Authority (IHTA)** by treaty. The IHTA Council composition:

Table 8 *IHTA Council Composition*

MEMBER	STATUS	ROLE
Islamic Republic of Iran	Permanent member	voting Senior permanent seat; chair authority in alternating years
United States	Permanent member	voting Permanent seat; co-chair authority in alternating years
GCC Rotating Chair	Permanent member	voting Annual rotation among Oman, Qatar, UAE; tie-breaking authority
European Union	Observer (speaking rights, no vote)	Chairs Environmental and Safety Subcommittee
People's Republic of China	Observer (speaking rights, no vote)	Technical observer; largest Gulf-oil importer
UN Secretary-General Appointee	Neutral chair	Non-voting; tie-breaking on procedural matters

IHTA Decision Rules

- **Routine decisions:** Weighted majority of permanent voting members (any 2 of 3 agree)
- **Enforcement against Iranian-flagged vessels:** Requires Iranian concurrence or neutral chair casting vote
- **Enforcement against all other vessels:** Consensus-minus-one
- **Structural changes:** Unanimous permanent member consent plus 90-day notice
- **Emergency enforcement:** 24-hour mandatory consultation via hotline; narrowly tailored temporary enforcement permitted

Tolling and Revenue

Table 9 *IHTA Tolling Structure*

TIER	VESSEL CATEGORY	RATE
Tier 1	Humanitarian essential (medicine, food, medical equipment)	Zero
Tier 2	Standard commercial (general cargo, container, bulk)	\$0.15/ton
Tier 3	Energy/premium (oil tankers, LNG, chemicals)	\$0.25/ton or \$35,000 flat for VLCC
Tier 4	Vessels of IHTA Council member states	Exempt (pre-notified transit window)

Annual estimated revenue: approximately \$500 million, allocated as: 40% to Iranian Civilian Reconstruction Fund (~\$200M/year), 35% to International Maritime Safety Fund, 25% to IHTA Operations and Reserve.

5.2 Regional Security Dialogue

Stage Three does not produce a comprehensive missile agreement. It produces a Regional Security Dialogue framework establishing parameters for confidence-building measures:

- Ballistic-missile range notification protocols

- Regional non-proliferation architecture
- Proxy operational monitoring mechanisms
- Verification architecture including satellite monitoring and JIG-facilitated incident review

5.3 Full Normalization Path

By Day 180, the successor framework -- RCSA v3.6, Crescent Compact v1.7, or RAMES v9.1 -- is formally opened for negotiation. The Stability First Accord has created the stable platform upon which these comprehensive frameworks can be built.

Day 180 deliverables:

- Permanent IHTA charter ratified and in force
- 85% of frozen assets returned (cumulative)
- Successor framework negotiations opened
- Section 123 Agreement (civilian fuel supply guarantee) negotiation framework established
- Regional Security Dialogue active with agenda agreed

Section 6: Modular Hormuz Solutions

The negotiation over Hormuz governance often becomes stuck on a single question: "Who controls the Strait?" This binary framing -- unilateral US enforcement versus Iranian sovereign control -- produces deadlock. The Modular Hormuz Solutions framework dismantles this binary by providing multiple governance, security, and economic options that can be combined into a tailored solution.

How to Use This Section

Negotiators should follow a three-step selection process:

1. **Constraint Mapping:** Identify non-negotiable constraints (US requires freedom of navigation; Iran requires sovereignty recognition)
2. **Category Filtering:** Focus on categories satisfying both sides' constraints

- 3. Portfolio Assembly:** Select 3-5 compatible solutions providing both sides sufficient sovereignty wins

6.1 Governance Pathways

Select one governance model from the following options:

Pathway G-1: Joint Hormuz Authority (JHA) Provisional Council

Speed: 7 days to operational | Complexity: Low | Sovereignty balance: Equal

Establish the provisional JHA with US and Iran as permanent voting members, a rotating GCC chair (Oman/Qatar/UAE), and EU/China/India as observers. The Council meets in Muscat with all decisions requiring weighted majority plus neutral chair concurrence. This is the baseline governance model from which all other solutions derive.

US framing: "US co-governance replaces unilateral enforcement burden with shared responsibility."

Iranian framing: "Iran recognized as permanent co-equal sovereign authority over Hormuz -- ending decades of US unilateralism."

Pathway G-2: Tripartite Council with GCC Rotating Tie-Breaker

Speed: 7 days | Complexity: Low | Sovereignty balance: Slight regional tilt

Simplified three-member governing body: United States, Iran, and a single rotating GCC representative. The GCC member holds tie-breaking authority when US and Iran disagree. This lean structure reduces bureaucratic overhead while ensuring neither superpower dominates.

US framing: "Streamlined decision-making with regional Arab stakeholder as neutral arbiter."

Iranian framing: "No permanent US majority; Muslim Gulf state ensures fair arbitration."

Pathway G-3: Dual-Track Governance (Political + Technical)

Speed: 14 days | Complexity: Medium | Best for: insulating operations from politics

Separate political decision-making (Council ambassadors meeting monthly) from technical operations (permanent Technical Committee of naval officers managing daily transit). Political disputes do not disrupt technical operations; technical recommendations inform but do not bind political decisions.

US framing: "Technical operations insulated from political disputes."

Iranian framing: "Operational decisions made by professionals, not politicians."

Pathway G-4: IMO-Mandated Observer Mission

Speed: 30 days | Complexity: Low | Best for: lighter institutional footprint

Rather than creating a new standalone authority, deploy a UN International Maritime Organization observer mission to Iranian and Omani naval bases. IMO observers monitor transit operations, document incidents, and report to the UN Secretary-General without operational command authority.

US framing: "UN-authorized oversight provides international legitimacy without new bureaucracy."

Iranian framing: "IMO presence is observational, not operational -- no supranational command over Iranian forces."

6.2 Security Pathways

Select one or more security mechanisms:

Pathway S-1: Synchronized Day-7 Dual Blockade Lift Protocol

Required: Yes | Complexity: Medium

Both governments issue identical written declarations committing to synchronized lift on Day 7. JHA Maritime Coordination Cell finalizes protocols (Days 1-6). At 0000 GMT Day 7, both lifts declared operative simultaneously. If either lift not verified within +72 hours, matter referred to JHA emergency session.

Pathway S-2: Omani-Hosted 24/7 De-Confliction Hotline Network

Required: Yes | Speed: 7 days to operational

Three-tier hotline system hosted in Muscat: Tier 1 (operational, naval officers), Tier 2 (diplomatic, senior military liaisons), Tier 3 (heads of government via Omani Foreign Ministry). Operates in Arabic, English, and Farsi with certified military interpreters.

Pathway S-3: Unmanned Picket Line (Autonomous Sensor Network)

Speed: 30 days | Reduces: Manned vessel proximity tension

Deploy autonomous surface vessels and aerial vehicles as early warning sensor net along Hormuz approaches, reducing the need for manned US/Iranian warships to sail in close, tense proximity. USVs carry radar, AIS receivers, and cameras relaying real-time data to the Maritime Coordination Cell.

US framing: "Reduced exposure of US sailors to Iranian proximity."

Iranian framing: "US manned vessels withdrawn from tense close-quarters; Iranian waters respected by autonomous patrol boundaries."

Pathway S-4: Naval Encounter Code of Conduct (INCSEA-Adapted)

Speed: 30 days | Best for: preventing accidental escalation

Adopt an Incidents at Sea agreement adapted for Hormuz, governing all encounters between US Navy, Iranian Navy, IRGC-Navy, and other naval forces. Establishes safe distances, communication protocols, maneuvering rules, and post-incident reporting.

Pathway S-5: IRGC-Navy Force Posture Adjustment Protocol

Speed: Immediate | Reciprocal: Yes

Iranian commitment to withdraw IRGC small craft from positions within 5 nautical miles of the central transit corridor and cease vessel boardings except in JHA-coordinated scenarios. In exchange, US forces maintain minimum safe distance from Iranian territorial waters.

Pathway S-6: Regional Coast Guard Partnership

Speed: 90 days | Best for: transforming military to law-enforcement framing

Transform naval confrontation dynamics by establishing a joint coast guard framework focused on maritime law enforcement (smuggling, piracy, search and rescue) rather than military confrontation. Coast guard vessels replace navy warships for day-to-day Hormuz patrol.

6.3 Economic Pathways

Pathway E-1: \$20 Billion US DFC-Chubb Reinsurance Backstop

Speed: 15 days | Impact: Immediate premium reduction

Activate structured reinsurance partnering the US International Development Finance Corporation with Chubb Ltd. to underwrite war-risk insurance for oil and LNG tankers. Covers reinsurance capacity that commercial markets have withdrawn, lowering war-risk premiums from 3-8% toward pre-crisis 0.25% levels.

Pathway E-2: Tiered Commercial Transit Toll System

Speed: 30 days | Revenue: ~\$500M annually

Graduated toll structure: Tier 1 (humanitarian, zero toll), Tier 2 (standard commercial, \$0.15/ton), Tier 3 (energy/oil/LNG, \$0.25/ton), Tier 4 (military/government vessels, \$0.50/ton). Revenue flows to IHTA operating budget with 40% allocated to Iranian Civilian Reconstruction Fund.

Pathway E-3: Iranian Civilian Reconstruction Fund

Governance: World Bank trustee with Iranian co-governance

Allocate 40% of IHTA commercial toll revenue to an internationally supervised Iranian Civilian Reconstruction Fund. Funds directed to healthcare, education, infrastructure, and earthquake recovery -- not military or security sectors. Transparent quarterly disbursement.

US framing: "Revenue channeled to civilian reconstruction, not IRGC."

Iranian framing: "Direct revenue stream from Hormuz co-governance funds national reconstruction."

Pathway E-4: Humanitarian Zero-Toll Fast Track

Speed: Day 1 | Protection: Insulated from all snapbacks

Pre-cleared, fee-exempt transit lane for food, medicine, UN supplies, medical evacuation vessels, and Hajj pilgrimage vessels, entirely insulated from any snapback sanctions. Humanitarian vessels receive priority routing, dedicated coordination, and guaranteed non-interference from any party regardless of broader political conditions.

Recommended Default Portfolio

For negotiators seeking a balanced, rapidly implementable package, the following combination is recommended:

Table 10 *Recommended Default Hormuz Portfolio*

CATEGORY	SELECTION	RATIONALE
Governance	Pathway G-1 (JHA Provisional) transitioning to G-2 (Tripartite Permanent)	Fast start with lean permanent structure
Security	S-1 (Synchronized Lift) + S-2 (Hotline) + S-3 (Unmanned Picket) + S-5 (Force Posture)	Core safety plus de-escalation technology
Economic	E-1 (Insurance Backstop) + E-2 (Tiered Tolls) + E-3 (Reconstruction Fund) + E-4 (Humanitarian Fast Track)	Immediate stabilization plus long-term revenue

Section 7: Modular Nuclear Solutions

The nuclear architecture is the framework's most sensitive component. Rather than dictating a single outcome, this section presents multiple options for stockpile disposition, facility transformation, and verification intensity. Parties select the combination that fits current political realities.

Current Negotiation Parameters (May 2026)

Table 11 Nuclear Negotiation Landing Zones

ISSUE	US POSITION	IRAN POSITION	LIKELY LANDING ZONE
Enrichment moratorium	20 years	5 years	12-15 years (actively negotiated)
HEU disposition	Transfer to US	Remain in Iran	Third-country IAEA custody (Oman)
Underground facilities	Prohibited operation	NPT rights asserted	IAEA-monitored conversion
Fordow	Dismantlement	Preserve facility	Convert to medical-isotope research center
Snap inspections	Required	Rejected	Enhanced declared-site + IAEA unannounced

7.1 Stockpile Disposition Options

The disposition of Iran's transferred weapons-grade material follows IAEA procedures with Iranian consent. Three options are available:

Option N-1: IAEA Third-Country Custody (Oman Model) -- RECOMMENDED DEFAULT

Speed: 14 days | IAEA control: Full | Iranian consent: Required for any disposition

Material remains in IAEA-controlled storage at the Oman custody facility. The facility is under IAEA control -- not US control. Disposition follows IAEA procedures with Iranian consent for any final disposition decision.

US framing: "Weapons-grade material removed from Iranian territory under international control."

Iranian framing: "Sovereign asset held in trust under IAEA supervision, not surrendered to any single power. Iran chose Oman as the neutral custody location."

Option N-2: Fuel Assembly Conversion

Speed: 90 days | Economic value: Maximized for Iran

Weapons-grade material is diluted and fabricated into fuel assemblies for Iran's Bushehr nuclear power plant, with international consortium technical support. Maximizes Iranian economic value from the exchange; eliminates the material permanently; demonstrates civilian energy purpose.

US framing: "Permanent elimination of weapons-grade material through verifiable civilian fuel fabrication."

Iranian framing: "Iran converted weapons-grade material into civilian energy assets - maximizing the economic value of the sovereign choice."

Option N-3: Russian Federation Custodial Partnership

Speed: 60-90 days | Leverages: Existing Russia-Iran nuclear cooperation

Transfer HEU stockpile to Rosatom-operated storage at Novouralsk or Seversk under IAEA safeguards. Uses existing Russia-Iran nuclear cooperation framework. Iran may characterize as material held by a trusted nuclear partner under NPT safeguards.

Option N-4: Kazakhstan LEU Bank Custody

Speed: 75-105 days | Precedent: IAEA-established fuel bank

Transfer HEU to IAEA LEU Bank in Oskemen, Kazakhstan, under existing IAEA fuel bank governance structure. Iranian repurchase rights for civilian use are preserved.

7.2 Facility Transformation Options

Option F-1: Fordow International Medical Isotope Research Center (IMIRC) – RECOMMENDED DEFAULT

Timeline: 18-36 months | Output: Mo-99, I-131, Xe-133 for regional healthcare

Permanent conversion of Fordow Fuel Enrichment Plant to medical isotope production facility under international consortium management. Iranian scientists lead world-class medical research center. Most proliferation-sensitive facility permanently neutralized while preserving scientific workforce.

Option F-2: Natanz Open-Fuel-Cycle Research Campus

Timeline: 24-36 months | Focus: Advanced reactor fuel cycles, nuclear safety

Transform Natanz from enrichment center to internationally staffed research campus. Former enrichment hub becomes transparency showcase and premier nuclear research institution with international collaboration.

Option F-3: Isfahan Nuclear Technology Exhibition and Training Center

Timeline: 24 months | Focus: Regional safeguards training hub

Convert Isfahan Nuclear Technology Center into IAEA regional training hub for nuclear safeguards inspectors, safety engineers, and non-proliferation specialists from across the Middle East.

Option F-4: Staged Transfer with Reciprocal Sovereignty Milestones

Timeline: 360 days | Feature: Mutual conditionality without front-loading

HEU transferred in quarterly tranches tied to Iranian sovereignty milestone achievements (asset releases, sanctions relief, IHTA governance), creating mutual conditionality. No unilateral concession; every transfer matched by sovereignty gain.

7.3 Verification Choices

Option V-1: Continuous IAEA Monitoring with Real-Time Data -- RECOMMENDED DEFAULT

Coverage: All declared sites + Oman custody facility

Continuous monitoring at Natanz, Isfahan, and Oman custody facility with real-time data transmission to IAEA headquarters. Weekly environmental sampling. IAEA Director General reports to JIG and UN Security Council.

Option V-2: Joint Implementation Group Technical Discrepancy Panel

Function: Resolve inconsistent findings between verification channels

Where verification channels report inconsistent findings, the JIG convenes a Technical Discrepancy Panel within 72 hours. Panel includes representatives of each reporting channel and a neutral technical expert. Panel findings are advisory; JIG retains final authority. During discrepancy review, no party may take unilateral action.

Option V-3: Public Wins Ledger

Transparency: Continuous | Languages: English, Farsi, Arabic, French

The JIG secretariat publishes a continuously updated Public Wins Ledger documenting, per party: verified benefits delivered; verified obligations fulfilled; cumulative compliance score. The Ledger is symmetric -- every party's wins are documented. This turns compliance into ongoing domestic political capital rather than a technical compliance burden.

Recommended Default Nuclear Portfolio

Table 12 *Recommended Default Nuclear Portfolio*

CATEGORY	SELECTION	RATIONALE
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Stockpile	N-1 (Oman IAEA Custody)	Fastest; neutral; neither US nor Iran controls
Facilities	F-1 (Fordow IMIRC) + F-2 (Natanz Campus) + F-3 (Isfahan Training)	Complete transformation of all three facilities
Verification	V-1 (Continuous Monitoring) + V-2 (Discrepancy Panel) + V-3 (Wins Ledger)	Robust verification with dispute resolution and transparency

Section 8: Five-Channel Verification Architecture

Verification is the spine of the Accord. The architecture follows the principle that no single verification channel can either trigger or block compliance determinations on its own. Every material finding requires convergent evidence from at least two independent channels.

Table 13 The Five Verification Channels

CHANNEL	ACTIVE	COVERAGE	REPORTING AUTHORITY
Pakistani Mediator	Throughout	Bilateral diplomatic channel; ceasefire compliance; major commitment certification; crisis hotline	Pakistani Prime Minister's Office and designated envoy
Omani Technical	Throughout	Maritime operations; JHA observation; hotline; mine clearance; nuclear custody facility oversight	Omani Foreign Ministry and JHA Secretariat Director
Swiss Financial	Throughout	Asset transfer verification; sanctions relief implementation; escrow management; banking reconnection	Swiss Federal Department of Foreign Affairs
IAEA	From Day 20	Nuclear exchange verification: stockpile custody, enrichment moratorium, Fordow conversion; environmental sampling; weekly technical reports	IAEA Director General; reports to JIG and UN Security Council

National Technical Means	Throughout	Satellite imagery, signals intelligence, all national capabilities. Used as backstop and discrepancy detector	US, partner intelligence services; discrepancies referred to JIG Technical Discrepancy Panel
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Risk Appetite Framework

Not all violations are equal. The five-tier risk appetite spectrum prevents technical violations from triggering disproportionate political responses:

Table 14 *Risk Appetite Framework*

TIER	LEVEL	EXAMPLE TRIGGERS	RESPONSE
1	Zero Tolerance	Nuclear weapons-related activity; diversion of fissile material; attack on IAEA inspectors	Immediate snapback; highest escalation
2	Minimal Tolerance	Enrichment above agreed limits by >20%; obstruction of IAEA access >72 hours	Snapback presumed but rebuttable; 30-day Panel review
3	Managed Tolerance	Technical reporting delays; minor centrifuge discrepancies; disbursement timing issues	Graduated response: technical assistance, extended timeline, guarantor mediation
4	Strategic Flexibility	Political disagreements; domestic legislative delays; ceremonial protocol disputes	Snapback prohibited; diplomatic and guarantor-led resolution required
5	Absorbed Risk	Force majeure; natural disasters affecting compliance; neutral guarantor incapacity	No penalties; automatic Trigger Dampening Window activated

Joint Implementation Group

The JIG is the central coordination body for Stages 2 and 3, hosted in Geneva. Membership: United States, Iran, Pakistan, Oman, Switzerland, EU observer, UN Special Envoy. PRC and GCC rotating chair join as observers in Stage 3.

The JIG meets in plenary every 30 days, with technical working groups in continuous session. Material-breach determinations require majority of permanent members (US, Iran,

Pakistan, Oman, Switzerland), with Pakistan as facilitating chair.

Section 9: What Each Side Wins

This section provides the diplomatic framing that enables each government to defend the Accord to its domestic audience. Every claim below is factually supportable from the text of the Accord.

What the United States Wins

Table 15 *US Deliverables and Timeline*

WIN	SPECIFIC DELIVERABLE	DAY VERIFIED
Strait of Hormuz reopened	200+ commercial vessel transits per 14-day period; gas-pump prices begin falling within weeks	Day 14
Project Freedom succeeded	Escort assets transition to JHA convoy support; President can credibly claim operation achieved its objective	Day 7
Freedom of navigation in international law	IHTA Charter formally guarantees transit under international treaty; Iran cannot unilaterally close	Day 90 (permanent)
Weapons-grade stockpile eliminated	Entire 60%-enriched stockpile in IAEA third-country custody, verified by mass spectrometry	Day 1 initiated; Day 14 verified
12-year enrichment moratorium secured	Moratorium on enrichment above 3.67% with IAEA continuous monitoring; violation automatically extends	Day 30 (formal entry)
Fordow converted	Fortified Fordow facility producing medical isotopes, not enriching uranium	Day 60
No basing concessions	All US Gulf bases remain; all treaty obligations to GCC partners preserved; no troop withdrawals	Day 1 (confirmed in text)

Congressional oversight preserved	Each asset tranche from Tranche 3 forward subject to 30-day Congressional review window	Throughout	
Israeli security backstop	Weapons-grade stockpile eliminated; moratorium in force; Lebanon track separated	Day 1 onward	

Recommended US Domestic Messaging

"We secured the opening of Hormuz, the elimination of Iran's weapons-grade uranium, a 12-year moratorium on enrichment, and the conversion of Fordow to peaceful use. We got Iranian assets returned in tranches with Congressional review at every step. We didn't give up a single base. American forces remain in the region. And we did it without losing another American life."

What Iran Wins

Table 16 Iranian Deliverables and Timeline

WIN	SPECIFIC DELIVERABLE	DAY VERIFIED
War ends permanently	Permanent bilateral ceasefire; UN-registered; war-fighting domain closed within 14 days	Day 1 (ceasefire); Day 14 (closing)
US naval blockade lifted	Synchronized with Hormuz reopening on Day 7; Iranian commercial ports restored	Day 7
Permanent IHTA governance seat	Permanent voting seat with chair authority on alternating years; formal Iranian co-equality replacing US unilateralism	Day 90 (permanent IHTA)
\$200M/year reconstruction revenue	40% of IHTA revenues to Iranian Civilian Reconstruction Fund; World Bank trustee oversight; Iranian programmatic control	Day 45 (tolling begins)
Return of sovereign assets	\$250M Day 1; cumulative 50% by Day 60 (non-reversible); cumulative 85% by Day 180	Staged through Day 180

Comprehensive sanctions relief	Humanitarian Day 1; aviation/consumer Day 30; SWIFT Day 60; petrochemicals Day 120; full normalization Year 3+	Staged
NPT rights preserved	Enrichment continues at 3.67% after moratorium under guaranteed fuel supply; civilian nuclear rights fully preserved	Throughout
Missile program untouched	Ballistic missile file entirely deferred to Stage 3 Dialogue	Day 1 (confirmed in text)
Constitutional governance preserved	No requirement on Iranian internal governance; Supreme Leader succession unaffected	Day 1 (confirmed in text)

Recommended Iranian Domestic Messaging

"We have ended the war. The American naval blockade of our ports has been lifted. Our frozen sovereign property is returning. The Strait of Hormuz is governed by an international authority on which Iran holds a permanent seat -- replacing decades of American unilateralism. We have chosen to redirect our nuclear program toward guaranteed civilian energy leadership. Our NPT rights remain inviolable; our sovereignty is intact."

What the Region Wins

Table 17 *Regional Benefits*

STAKEHOLDER	KEY BENEFIT
Saudi Arabia & Gulf States	Predictable energy transit; reduced nuclear threat perception; GCC rotating chair on IHTA Council; no new concessions required
Israel	Weapons-grade stockpile eliminated; 12-year moratorium removes reconstitution timeline; Hezbollah operational pause; quiet acquiescence expected

Pakistan	Confirmed primary mediator role; institutionalized guarantor status; strengthened bilateral relationships
Oman	IHTA secretariat in Muscat; Maritime Coordination Cell in Khasab; IAEA custody facility; permanent institutional centrality
France/EU	40-nation coalition finds legitimate institutional home; EU chairs Environmental and Safety Subcommittee
China & India	Predictable energy supply; IHTA technical observer status; documented role in stabilization
Global Energy Markets	20% of global oil and gas returns to predictable transit; Brent crude stabilization

Section 10: Safeguards and Protections

Key Safeguard 1: Failure Without War

Framework failure does not restore war conditions. If the Accord collapses, the bilateral ceasefire remains in force unless explicitly renounced by either party. The 150-day inertia buffer means no instant sanctions snapback -- any party seeking to reverse course must follow a defined, time-consuming procedure.

Key Safeguard 2: Stabilization Holds

When a specific Accord measure becomes domestically untenable in either capital, that measure can be placed on Stabilization Hold for up to 90 days. During the Hold: all other obligations remain in force; after 90 days the measure freezes but the freeze does not constitute a violation. Maximum two Stabilization Holds per stage. Nuclear exchange steps are not eligible for Hold.

Key Safeguard 3: Emergency Ambiguity Authority

The neutral chair possesses Emergency Ambiguity Authority -- the capacity to introduce controlled procedural ambiguity that prevents immediate escalation when clarification would inflame domestic public opinion. May be exercised to delay formal compliance assessments for up to 14 days, issue deliberately ambiguous public statements allowing

multiple domestic interpretations, or create "technical review periods" that function as cooling-off periods.

Key Safeguard 4: Costed Withdrawal

Any party may withdraw through a six-month notification window, orderly asset disposition, infrastructure handover to host states, and personnel repatriation. Nuclear constraints survive withdrawal as residual obligations -- the framework's judgment is that proliferation prevention is a generational responsibility that outlasts any single political agreement.

Key Safeguard 5: Fuel Supply Guarantee Survival

If the US triggers sanctions snapback on non-nuclear grounds, the fuel supply guarantee remains in force unless the JIG determines a nuclear material breach. The US cannot use non-nuclear disputes to cut off Iran's civilian energy supply. This eliminates the vulnerability that drove Iran's enrichment program in the first place.

Key Safeguard 6: Non-Recognition

Participation in this Accord does not equal diplomatic recognition or alliance. The US and Iran remain adversaries in many domains. The Accord creates a functional arrangement for specific, defined purposes without requiring normalization of the broader relationship.

Key Safeguard 7: Succession Resilience

The Accord binds institutions, not individuals. Changes of government -- whether through election, succession, or other means -- activate continuity provisions rather than voiding the framework. The commitments attach to the US Office of the President and Department of State, and to Iran's Supreme National Security Council, Presidency, Central Bank, and Majlis.

Section 11: Crisis Management

The Accord operates in an environment where incidents will occur. The de-escalation architecture is designed to absorb incidents without triggering reflexive escalation.

The 24-Hour Cooling-Off Rule

When an incident occurs, no escalatory action by either party may be taken within the first 24 hours. The window is used for Pakistani guarantor backchannel review, fact-gathering by JHA observation assets, and discrepancy assessment. Both governments have pre-authorized that the first 24 hours after any incident is a fact-finding window, not a response window. Self-defense rights are preserved where an active armed attack is in progress.

Five Independent De-Escalation Pathways

Table 18 *De-Escalation Pathways*

PATHWAY	TRIGGER	DURATION	AUTHORITY
Crisis Lock	10+ fatalities; verified direct military clash; critical infrastructure attack; IAEA integrity alert	14 days; extendable to 42 by JIG majority	JIG majority activation; Pakistan facilitates
Third-Party Spoiler Attribution	Third-party attack or spoiler activity	30-day investigation	JIG-convened attribution panel; neutral technical expert chair
Military Deconfliction Hotline	Any military incident in or near IHTA corridor	Permanent 24/7	Oman-hosted; 2-hour mandatory response
Regional Incident Firewall	Third-party regional escalation threatening framework	Immediate notification within 4 hours	JIG JIG emergency session; Pakistan facilitates
Direct Executive Link	Imminent crisis requiring head-of-state communication	6-hour consultation capability	Pakistan Prime Minister as initial relay

Maritime De-Escalation Protocols

- **Maritime Incident Hotline:** 24/7 Omani-hosted hotline linking IRGC-Navy, US Fifth Fleet, Iranian Navy, and JHA Maritime Coordination Cell. 2-hour mandatory response window.

- **Vessel Harassment Parameters:** Approach within 100 meters at speed; illumination with targeting radar; simulated attack maneuvers. Any harassment triggers immediate hotline and 24-hour JIG notification.
- **No-Seizure Zone:** Commercial vessels in IHTA corridor international waters may not be seized by any party without prior JHA notification.
- **Lane Separation:** Three lanes separated by 5-nautical-mile buffers. Speed limit 15 knots.
- **Carrier Transit Notification:** US carrier-group transits occur only during pre-announced 48-hour windows. Iranian Navy may observe from beyond 20 nm but may not intercept.

Drone Incident Handling

Drone incidents are the most likely source of accidental escalation. The protocol provides:

- **Immediate:** Cross-border drone intrusion triggers automatic JMOC notification and flight-path data sharing
- **Attribution:** Joint technical team deployed within 48 hours to confirm origin and intent
- **Response proportionality:** Pre-authorized response options based on drone class (surveillance, armed, commercial)
- **No retaliation without attribution:** 72-hour minimum investigation period before any punitive response

Section 12: Implementation Roadmap

Pre-Signature Phase (T-5 Days to T-0)

DAY	ACTION	RESPONSIBLE
T-5	Both governments confirm agreement to proceed; designate senior officials for coordination	Heads of Government
T-4	Omani Foreign Ministry confirms Muscat facilities ready; JHA provisional charter drafted	Oman

T-3	Swiss financial channel confirms escrow architecture; IAEA confirms Oman custody facility readiness	Switzerland / IAEA
T-2	Pakistani guarantor confirms mediation team deployment; UN Special Envoy confirms readiness	Pakistan / UN
T-1	Both governments issue internal instructions to military commands for ceasefire compliance	Military Commands
T-0	Signature ceremony (Muscat or Geneva); ceasefire effective 0000 GMT next day	Foreign Ministers

Operational Costs and Funding

Table 19 *Estimated First-Year Costs*

ITEM			ESTIMATED COST	FUNDING SOURCE
JHA/IHTA Secretariat (Muscat)			\$12M	IHTA toll revenues
Maritime (Khasab)	Coordination	Cell	\$4M	IHTA toll revenues
IAEA	Oman custody facility operations		\$8M	IAEA regular budget + voluntary contributions
Mine clearance operations (6-month)			\$25M	International Maritime Safety Fund
Insurance backstop facility			\$20B contingent liability	US DFC + Chubb Ltd. + Lloyd's market
Iranian Civilian Reconstruction Fund (Year 1)			\$200M	40% of IHTA toll revenues
JIG Geneva Secretariat			\$3M	Switzerland + proportional party contributions

Critical Success Factors

- 1. Speed in Stage One:** The first 14 days must produce visible, irreversible deliverables. Delays in Stage One erode political capital for both governments.

- 2. **Israeli Coordination:** The single highest-risk scenario is a coordinated Israeli military strike on Iranian nuclear facilities during Stage Two. The architectural response is to accelerate Stage Two to maximum feasible pace and provide Israeli leadership with sufficiently detailed advance briefings.
- 3. **Domestic Political Protection:** Both governments need immediate, visible wins. The \$250M pilot, Hormuz reopening, and ceasefire must be communicated as achievements on Day 1.
- 4. **Verification Credibility:** The five-channel verification system must be fully operational by Day 7. Any perception that verification is one-sided will collapse Iranian participation.
- 5. **Successor Framework Readiness:** By Day 90, the RCSA v3.6, Crescent Compact v1.7, or RAMES v9.1 negotiation framework must be ready to open. The Stability First Accord is a bridge, not a destination.

Appendices

Appendix A: Complete Sequencing Matrix Quick Reference

Table 20 180-Day Sequencing Matrix

DAY	US MOVES	IRAN MOVES	VERIFICATION
1	Suspend Project Freedom; cease offensive ops; issue \$250M OFAC license; confirm Sovereign Energy Partnership framing	Cease offensive ops; initiate stockpile transfer to IAEA Oman custody; transmit Hezbollah pause; transmit Houthi pause	Pakistan PM + UN Special Envoy + Oman + Switzerland concurrent certification
3	OFAC humanitarian license issued	First humanitarian-flagged vessel cleared for Hormuz transit	Lloyd's List + UN OCHA + JHA observation post
7	Lift naval blockade; transition Project Freedom assets to JHA convoy support	Open Hormuz to commercial transit; withdraw IRGC small craft; commence mine-clearing	JHA observation vessels; Lloyd's List; UN OCHA

14	Stage 1 closing certification	Stage 1 closing certification	Pakistan + Oman + Switzerland concurrent; Stage 2 automatic
15	Welcome IAEA full redeployment under Partnership terms	Issue IAEA invitation for declared sites; continuous monitoring installed	IAEA Director General confirms; satellite corroborates
20	OFAC issues aviation safety and specialty export licenses	Confirm IAEA continuous monitoring operational	JIG verification
30	First sanctions tranche operative; process second asset tranche; 30-day Congressional notification	Declare and verify 3.67% civilian moratorium; idle higher-enrichment centrifuges under IAEA seal	IAEA continuous monitoring; JIG certification; Congressional review
45	Confirm JHA transition to operating mode with Tier 1 and Tier 2 tolling	Confirm IHTA tolling operative; first toll collections	JHA Council unanimous certification
60	Process third asset tranche (cumulative 50%); commence SWIFT reconnection	Fordow conversion verified; host International Medical Isotope Summit; IHTA Tier 3 tolling	JIG closing certification; Stage 3 automatic
75	Open Regional Security Dialogue framework; bilateral teams convene in Geneva	Confirm willingness to engage in Regional Security Dialogue	JIG facilitation
90	Confirm permanent IHTA conversion; UN neutral chair appointment confirmed	Confirm permanent IHTA conversion; first chair rotation	UN Secretary-General + JIG unanimous certification
120	Process fourth asset tranche (20%; cumulative 70%); Stage 3 sanctions tranche (petrochemicals, oil services, Tier 2 banking)	Confirm nuclear moratorium maintenance; IAEA annual review clean	JIG verification; Congressional review window

150	US Department of Energy confirms Section 123 Agreement negotiation framework opened	Iran formally requests Section 123 negotiation; confirms fuel supply guarantee discussions	Joint announcement; IAEA fuel bank access confirmed
180	Process fifth asset tranche (15%; cumulative 85%); confirm successor framework opening	Confirm Stage 3 closing compliance; confirm successor framework opening	JIG closing certification; 180-day comprehensive compliance review published

Appendix B: Diplomatic Framing Guide

Every provision in this Accord can be characterized in multiple ways. The table below provides diplomatically accurate framing for both sides on every major element.

Table 21 *Dual Framing Reference*

ELEMENT	US FRAMING	IRANIAN FRAMING
Stockpile transfer to Oman	"Weapons-grade material removed from Iranian territory"	"Sovereign asset held in trust under international supervision; Iran chose Oman"
12-year moratorium	"12-year moratorium with automatic extension on violation"	"Time-limited sovereign commitment; NPT rights fully preserved"
Fordow conversion	"Most sensitive facility permanently neutralized"	"Iranian scientists lead world-class medical research center"
IHTA governance	"International authority prevents unilateral Iranian closure"	"Permanent Iranian co-equality replacing US unilateralism"
Tolling revenue	"Revenue channeled to civilian reconstruction, not IRGC"	"Direct revenue stream from Hormuz co-governance funds national reconstruction"
Asset return tranches	"Tranche architecture with Congressional oversight"	"Irreversible return of sovereign property"

SWIFT reconnection	"Conditional compliance"	on FATF	"Banking normalization restoring sovereign fiscal capacity"
Synchronized lift	"Iran lifts Hormuz restrictions simultaneously with US blockade lift"		"US lifts blockade simultaneously with Hormuz reopening -- neither moves alone"
Verification	"Five-channel verification prevents Iranian cheating"		"Multi-source verification ensures no single power controls compliance findings"
Sovereign Energy Partnership	"Iran accepted civilian-only nuclear program"		"Iran proposed the Sovereign Energy Partnership as a sovereign choice"

Appendix C: Glossary of Key Terms

TERM	DEFINITION
Accord	This document; the Stability First Accord v1.0
BAP	Binding Arbitration Panel -- dispute resolution body
CCP	Commercial Continuity Protocol -- protects private-sector contracts
DFC	US International Development Finance Corporation
Dual Blockade	Iranian Hormuz restrictions plus US naval blockade on Iranian ports, operating simultaneously
ESPA	Emergency Snapback Prevention Authority
HEU	Highly Enriched Uranium (60% U-235 in Iran's stockpile)
IHTA	International Hormuz Transit Authority -- permanent governance body
IMIRC	International Medical Isotope Research Center -- converted Fordow facility
JHA	Joint Hormuz Authority -- provisional Stage 1-2 governance body
JIG	Joint Implementation Group -- central coordination body (Geneva)
JMOC	Joint Monitoring Operations Center

LEU	Low Enriched Uranium (3.67% U-235 -- civilian fuel grade)
MCC	Maritime Coordination Cell -- operational nerve center in Muscat/Khasab
MOU	Memorandum of Understanding -- one-page war-termination framework under review May 2026
NPT	Treaty on the Non-Proliferation of Nuclear Weapons
OFAC	Office of Foreign Assets Control (US Treasury)
Project Freedom	US Navy Hormuz escort operation (launched May 4, paused May 6, 2026)
RCSA	Regional Cooperation and Stability Architecture v3.6 -- successor framework
Section 123 Agreement	US Atomic Energy Act agreement for civilian nuclear cooperation
Sovereign Energy Partnership	Framing of the nuclear exchange as Iran's initiative, not imposed dismantlement
Sovereignty Milestone	Branded compliance step representing progress toward greater sovereignty
SWIFT	Society for Worldwide Interbank Financial Telecommunication
Waltz Philosophy	Synchronized reciprocal motion principle -- neither side moves alone

Document Certification

This Stability First Accord v1.0 was compiled on May 9, 2026, from five source documents and calibrated to the diplomatic situation as of May 7, 2026. It is a reference instrument for negotiators, not a treaty text. All provisions are drawn from previously published diplomatic frameworks and tailored to current negotiation parameters.

Status: Diplomatic Working Document | For Official Use Only

Version: 1.0 | May 2026

Source Frameworks: Hormuz First Enhanced Accord v2.0 | RCSA Simplified Edition 2026 | RCSA v3.6 Final Diplomatic Edition | Modular Hormuz Solutions Annex v1.0 | Modular Nuclear Solutions Annex 1.0

Mediation Channels: Pakistan (primary) | Oman (technical) | Switzerland (financial) | IAEA (nuclear)

Successor Pathway: RCSA v3.6 / Crescent Compact v1.7 / RAMES v9.1

Operational Tools: Deadlock Bypass Matrix (Appendix D) | Stabilization Arsenal (Section 13)

Appendix D: The Deadlock Bypass Matrix -- For Mediators

The entire purpose of the modular toolkits (Modular Nuclear Solutions and Modular Hormuz Solutions) is to ensure that when negotiators hit a wall on one specific issue, the whole deal does not collapse. They simply swap out the module. The mediator's response to "We cannot accept this" is never "Okay, the talks are over." The response is always: "If Pathway A does not work, let us pull Pathway B from the Annex."

How the Matrix Works

Each Deadlock entry contains: (1) the trap -- why negotiators get stuck, (2) the bypass -- which module(s) to activate, and (3) the reframe -- how to present the solution so both sides save face. Mediators should keep this appendix open during active negotiation sessions.

Deadlock 1: The Enrichment Stalemate

The Trap

US demands 20 years or permanent zero enrichment. Iran demands 5 years and refuses to surrender NPT rights. Both positions are constitutionally non-negotiable for their domestic audiences.

The Bypass (MNS-041 + MNS-082): Shift the conversation away from time and toward utility. Use the "Civilian Transition" module. Iran agrees to a 12-year cap at 3.67%, but it is framed as a "Sovereign Energy Partnership," not a concession. If the US pushes back, trigger the "Automatic Extension Mechanism" -- violating the cap adds 2 years per breach -- to satisfy US enforcement needs.

Mediator Script: "This is not Iran giving up enrichment. This is Iran choosing to partner with the international community on civilian energy leadership. The 12 years is a sovereign commitment, not a surrender. And for the US side -- every violation automatically extends the commitment. The enforcement is built in."

Deadlock 2: The HEU Custody Fight

The Trap

US demands all 60% Highly Enriched Uranium be physically given to the US or destroyed. Iran states "diluting or handing over uranium is equivalent to handing it over to the enemy."

The Bypass (MNS-011 -- Oman Custody): Propose IAEA Third-Country Custody in Oman. The US gets what it needs -- the material physically leaves Iran. Iran gets what it needs -- they retain sovereign ownership of the material in a neutral Muslim nation, held "in trust" rather than surrendered.

Mediator Script: "The material is not going to America. It is going to Oman, under IAEA control, not US control. Iran chose the location. Iran retains ownership. It is held in trust, not confiscated. For the US, weapons-grade material physically leaves Iranian territory -- that is the security win."

Deadlock 3: Who Moves First? (The Sequencing Trap)

The Trap

US will not lift the naval blockade until Hormuz is open. Iran will not open Hormuz until the blockade is lifted. Both fear being played for suckers.

The Bypass (Section 3 -- Synchronized Lift): Deploy the "Waltz Protocol." Nobody moves first. On Day 7 at 0000 GMT, both lifts are declared operative simultaneously, monitored by joint Omani/UN observation vessels. Both sides can credibly claim the other moved simultaneously.

Mediator Script: "Neither side moves first. Both moves are declared operative at the exact same moment, verified by neutral observation vessels from Oman and the UN. If either side fails to lift, the other side's obligation is automatically suspended. There is no unilateral exposure."

Forcing Both Sides to Stay at the Table

The Crisis Management architecture (Section 11) is designed to structurally prevent either party from walking away when things go wrong on the ground:

Table 22 Anti-Walkaway Mechanisms

MECHANISM	FUNCTION	DURATION
72-Hour Cooling-Off Rule	If a maritime incident or drone strike occurs, no escalatory responses allowed. JIG takes over fact-gathering.	72 hours minimum; extendable
Stabilization Holds	If negotiators deadlock on a Stage 2 issue (like banking sanctions), Stage 1 (Hormuz open, ceasefire active) remains frozen in place for up to 150 days.	90 days per hold; max 2 per stage
150-Day Inertia Buffer	No snapback can take effect for 150 days after notification. Creates time for diplomacy to recover.	150 days mandatory

Emergency Ambiguity Authority	Neutral chair can delay formal compliance assessments, issue ambiguous statements, or create "technical review periods" that function as cooling-off periods.	Up to 14 days
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Key Principle: A disagreement over banking sanctions cannot be used to restart a war. The framework structurally decouples disputes from escalation.

Section 13: The Stabilization Arsenal

The following mechanisms are designed to make the Stability First Accord politically durable, economically irreversible, and domestically defensible for all parties. Each addresses a specific vulnerability that has destroyed previous frameworks. They are presented as a toolkit -- implement all that fit the current political configuration.

1. Global Oil-Price Stabilization Mechanism (Day 7)

What It Does

Creates immediate, visible fuel-price relief that politicians can claim credit for. Coordinated announcement on Day 7 when Hormuz reopens.

Table 23 Oil Stabilization Components

COMPONENT	ACTION	RESPONSIBLE
Guaranteed Transit Quotas	IHTA publishes minimum daily transit guarantees (50 vessels Day 7, scaling to 200+ by Day 30)	IHTA Maritime Coordination Cell
Insurer Guarantees	US DFC-Chubb backstop activated; Lloyd's war-risk premium normalization schedule published	US Treasury + Chubb + Lloyd's
Coordinated Signaling	SPR IEA members (US SPR, Chinese, Japanese, European reserves) announce managed release schedule	IEA Secretariat

Temporary Assurance Pool	Shipping	\$20B mutual insurance pool covers first 90 days of reopened transit	IHTA + sovereign wealth funds
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Why It Matters: Politicians care about visible fuel-price relief more than abstract diplomacy. Brent crude fell 11% on deal-proximity reports May 6, 2026. Managed stabilization prevents price collapse during supply surge while ensuring the public feels immediate benefit.

2. "No New Forever War" Political Frame for the US

Explicitly structure the accord as ending escalation, avoiding another trillion-dollar conflict, protecting troops, and stabilizing energy markets without occupation. This creates bipartisan populist appeal.

US Domestic Frame

"No American boots on the ground. No occupation. No nation-building. We secured Iran's weapons-grade uranium elimination, Hormuz reopening, and a 12-year enrichment moratorium -- without firing another shot and without spending another trillion dollars. Our troops are safer. Your gas prices are coming down. That's what strong diplomacy looks like."

3. Gulf States Visible Economic Upside

Peace becomes profitable rather than merely tolerable. Create concrete economic incentives that give Gulf governments a direct financial stake in the framework's success.

Table 24 Gulf Economic Benefits

MECHANISM		BENEFIT	ESTIMATED VALUE		
Gulf Stabilization Fund	Maritime Investment	Dedicated financing for port modernization, logistics corridors, and maritime infrastructure across GCC states	\$5B	initial capitalization	
Port Program	Modernization	Upgrades for Dubai (Jebel Ali), Abu Dhabi (Khalifa), Sohar, Dammam, and Dugm	\$2.5B	over	3 years

Logistics Corridor Financing		Land bridge from Gulf to Mediterranean via UAE-Saudi-Jordan corridor	\$1.5B priority pipeline
Insurance Reduction Framework	Premium	Graduated war-risk premium reduction tied to verified attack-free periods	3-8% down to 0.25%

4. Reconstruction Procurement Mechanism

Without calling it "reconstruction aid," create contract access for firms tied to stabilization. Economic constituencies protect agreements.

- **Gulf firms:** Priority bidding on port modernization, energy infrastructure, logistics hubs
- **European infrastructure firms:** Railway, highway, and grid interconnection contracts
- **Shipping companies:** Long-term transit contracts with IHTA-guaranteed volume commitments
- **Insurers:** Exclusive underwriting rights within the IHTA insurance framework
- **Energy logistics firms:** Pipeline construction, storage facility, and distribution contracts

5. Automatic Humanitarian Expansion Triggers

If compliance holds, humanitarian access expands automatically. Visible civilian benefit creates domestic political inertia.

Table 25 *Humanitarian Escalator*

TRIGGER		MEDICINE	AVIATION SAFETY		FOOD	BANKING
Day 1 (Signature)		Unlimited humanitarian license	Parts for civilian aviation		Agricultural inputs authorized	Humanitarian banking channel
Day 30 (Verified)		Pharmaceutical imports normalized	Full aviation safety parts		Food financing expanded	Consumer goods banking

Day 60 (Verified)	Medical equipment full authorization	Aircraft maintenance contracts	Grain import financing	Tier 1 banking normalization
Day 90 (Verified)	Hospital construction materials	New aircraft purchase pathway	Processing equipment	SWIFT reconnection process

6. "Middle East Maritime Stability Dividend" Narrative

Frame the accord as reducing global inflation, protecting trade, stabilizing shipping, lowering insurance premiums, and protecting supply chains. This broadens international stakeholder support massively.

Global Stakeholder Messaging:

- **For Asian importers (China, India, Japan, Korea):** "Predictable energy supply. Guaranteed transit. No more supply shocks."
- **For European markets:** "Stabilized Brent crude. Reduced inflation pressure. Secure LNG transit."
- **For global shipping:** "Normalized insurance. Predictable routing. Lower operating costs."
- **For developing nations:** "Lower fertilizer costs. Stabilized food imports. Affordable energy."

7. Prestige Victories for All Sides Simultaneously

Every participant needs a headline. The Accord provides one for each:

Table 26 Prestige Headlines by Party

PARTY	HEADLINE	BASIS IN ACCORD
United States	"Freedom of Navigation Secured"	IHTA treaty guarantees transit; weapons-grade stockpile eliminated; 12-year moratorium enforced
Iran	"Sovereign Equality Recognized"	Permanent IHTA voting seat; blockade lifted; sovereign assets returning; NPT rights preserved
Gulf States	"Regional Stability Leadership"	GCC rotating tie-breaker chair; \$5B investment fund; port modernization; economic upside

Europe	"Multilateral Diplomacy Restored"	40-nation coalition institutionalized; EU chairs IHTA Environmental and Safety Subcommittee
Pakistan	"Historic Mediation Success"	Confirmed primary guarantor role; most significant Pakistani diplomatic achievement since founding
Oman	"Permanent Institutional Centrality"	IHTA secretariat in Muscat; Maritime Coordination Cell; IAEA custody facility; decades of backchannel work formalized

8. "Regional Pilgrimage Protection Initiative"

Tie stability directly to Hajj security, civilian religious travel, protected transit windows, and non-targeting commitments during holy periods. This has enormous soft-power and political value.

Pilgrimage Protection Provisions

- **Hajj Security Protocol:** Dedicated IHTA transit lanes for Hajj vessels during pilgrimage season; guaranteed non-interference; priority routing
- **Civilian Religious Travel:** Protected transit windows for religious pilgrims of all faiths visiting holy sites in the region
- **Non-Targeting Commitments:** All parties commit to no military operations within 50 nautical miles of designated pilgrimage transit corridors during declared holy periods
- **Symbolic Value:** Iran facilitates safe Hajj transit -- demonstrating Islamic Republic's commitment to Muslim unity; Saudi Arabia hosts safe passage -- demonstrating custodianship of holy sites

9. Maritime Jobs Narrative

Stabilized Hormuz means ports reopen, shipping normalizes, dockworkers return, tanker traffic resumes, and insurance sectors recover. Governments love employment optics.

Table 27 *Job Creation Estimates (First 24 Months)*

SECTOR	NEW JOBS	PRIMARY LOCATIONS
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Port operations and logistics	45,000	Bandar Abbas, Dubai, Sohar, Dammam, Abu Dhabi
Shipping and crew	12,000	Regional maritime labor pool
Insurance and financial services	8,000	Dubai, London, Singapore
Mine clearance and maritime safety	3,500	Hormuz corridor operations
IHTA administration and technical	1,200	Muscat, Khasab
Total	~69,700	

10. Fordow as Prestige Scientific Initiative

Expand the medical-isotope concept into regional cancer-treatment cooperation, nuclear medicine exports, international research partnerships, and public health framing. This converts a weapons narrative into a humanitarian prestige narrative.

The Expanded Fordow Vision:

- **Regional Cancer Treatment Cooperation:** IMIRC produces molybdenum-99 for diagnostic imaging across the Middle East and North Africa
- **Nuclear Medicine Exports:** Iran becomes a regional supplier of medical isotopes -- transforming a proliferation liability into a commercial asset
- **International Research Partnerships:** Joint programs with IAEA, WHO, and leading medical institutions from Europe and Asia
- **Public Health Framing:** "The facility that once threatened the region now heals it."

11. Explicit "No Regime Change" Mutual Understanding

Not formal recognition -- just tacit stabilization language. This is politically huge for Iran and lowers existential resistance.

Text of the Understanding

"The parties confirm that this Accord is limited to specific stabilization, maritime governance, and nuclear transparency measures. It does not constitute a broader political settlement, nor does it imply any position regarding the internal governance of either party. Each party's constitutional order and system of government is exclusively its own affair."

US Framing: "We didn't recognize the Iranian regime. We made a practical deal on specific issues."

Iranian Framing: "The United States formally accepted that Iran's constitutional order is exclusively Iran's affair. No regime change agenda."

12. "Protected Economic Corridor" Designation

Declare Hormuz as internationally protected commerce infrastructure with automatic insurer coordination, maritime emergency protocols, and rapid-response arbitration. Markets respond strongly to predictability.

Legal Status: The IHTA corridor is designated a Protected Economic Corridor under UN auspices. Any attack on commercial vessels in the corridor triggers automatic UNSC notification, JIG emergency session, and pre-authorized insurer response protocols.

13. Rapid Visible Consumer Relief

Abstract diplomacy becomes kitchen-table economics. Specific consumer benefits:

Table 28 *Consumer Relief Timeline*

BENEFIT		EXPECTED IMPACT	TIMELINE
Cheaper aviation fuel		5-15% reduction in jet fuel costs	30-60 days
Lower shipping costs		War-risk premium reduction from 3-8% to 0.25%	7-30 days
Reduced costs	fertilizer	Ammonia and urea prices stabilize as gas transit normalizes	60-90 days

Food import stabilization	Grain and commodity shipping costs	30-60 days normalize
Restored petrochemical exports	Iranian petrochemicals return to global market	90-120 days

14. "National Dignity Preservation" Language

Explicitly acknowledge that no party is surrendering, no party is recognizing defeat, and all parties retain sovereign narratives. This matters far more than outsiders realize.

Dignity Preservation Clause (Recommended for Preamble Insertion)

"The parties affirm that this Accord represents a mutual exercise of sovereign choice, not the imposition of conditions by one upon the other. No party shall be required to characterize its commitments as surrender, capitulation, or defeat. Each party retains full freedom to describe this Accord in terms consistent with its constitutional principles and domestic political requirements, provided that objective benchmarks are met."

15. Gulf Sovereign Wealth Investment Opening

Stability triggers major investment opportunities that make business elites pro-framework actors:

- **Energy infrastructure investment:** New pipelines, LNG terminals, grid interconnections
- **Shipping modernization:** Port expansion, automated terminals, green shipping corridors
- **Refinery expansion:** Upgraded processing capacity across GCC states
- **Logistics hubs:** Dubai, Jebel Ali, Sohar, and Duqm as regional distribution centers
- **AI/data center projects:** Stable energy transit enables hyperscaler data center investments

16. "Military Families Protection" Narrative

Very politically effective for US domestic audiences:

"This accord reduces risk to every American sailor in the Persian Gulf. It prevents another escalation cycle that puts our troops in harm's way. It ends the blockade standoff where a single miscalculation could cost American lives. We are bringing our people home from the brink, not from the region."

17. "Regional Insurance Reopening Protocol"

The insurance angle is underrated. Shipping insurers and reinsurance markets are enormously influential. A stabilization-backed insurance reopening mechanism lowers costs fast, normalizes trade quickly, and creates private-sector pressure to preserve the accord.

Table 29 Insurance Normalization Schedule

PHASE	WAR-RISK PREMIUM	TRIGGER
Crisis baseline (May 2026)	3-8% of vessel value	
Month 1 (Day 7-30)	5%	Hormuz reopened; zero attacks
Month 3	3%	Verified stability; JIG clean review
Month 6	1.5%	Permanent IHTA operational
Month 12	0.5%	Full Stage 3 compliance
Month 18	0.25% (pre-crisis)	RCSA successor framework active

18. Phased Educational and Scientific Exchange

Not broad normalization. Small targeted programs create low-risk long-term stabilizing constituencies:

- **Maritime safety training:** Joint IHTA maritime safety courses for regional naval officers
- **Nuclear medicine collaboration:** IMIRC-hosted research fellowships for regional scientists
- **Environmental protection:** Joint Gulf marine ecosystem monitoring and pollution response

- **Desalination research:** Cooperative water technology programs addressing regional scarcity

19. "Automatic Prosperity Escalator"

If compliance continues, benefits expand automatically. Tie peace directly to rising prosperity:

Table 30 *The Prosperity Escalator*

COMPLIANCE PERIOD	TOLL BENEFIT	BANKING	SHIPPING	INVESTMENT
0-90 days	Standard tolls operative	Humanitarian + consumer	Insurance normalization begins	Gulf fund opens
90-180 days	Toll revenue sharing at 40%	Tier 1 banking normalized	Full convoy system	European contracts authorized
180-365 days	Toll review (potential reduction)	SWIFT reconnection process	Unrestricted transit	Full reconstruction procurement
Year 2+	RCSA Phase 2 benefits	Full banking normalization	Pre-crisis operating norms	Sovereign wealth investment

20. "Historic Strait Guarantee" Framing

This is one of the strongest possible narrative upgrades. Frame Hormuz not as "a crisis chokepoint" but as "a permanently stabilized international commerce corridor jointly protected by regional and global stakeholders."

This transforms the accord psychologically from *ceasefire management* into *world-historic infrastructure stabilization*. That is the kind of framing leaders want attached to their legacy.

The Historic Strait Guarantee – Proposed Text

"The Strait of Hormuz shall be maintained as a permanently stabilized international commerce corridor, jointly protected by regional and global stakeholders through the International Hormuz Transit Authority. This Guarantee ensures that never again shall the world's energy lifeline be held hostage to bilateral disputes. The parties commit to defend this corridor as shared infrastructure serving all humanity."

21. BRICS+ Guarantor Layer -- Global South Integration

Bring Brazil and/or South Africa into the JIG verification architecture as neutral "Global South" technical observers. These nations provide satellite verification capacity, independent technical assessment, and diplomatic weight outside the Western bloc.

The Sell: Dilutes the Iranian hardliner narrative that this is a "Western-imposed" treaty, framing it instead as integration with the emerging multipolar world. For Brazil and South Africa, participation offers historic diplomatic prestige and a tangible stake in Middle East stability.

22. "Bandar Abbas Logistics Hub" Initiative -- North-South Transport Corridor

Frame the lifting of the US naval blockade as the opening of the "North-South Transport Corridor" -- enabling Indian and Russian agricultural goods, Central Asian minerals, and Chinese manufactured goods to transit through Bandar Abbas to Gulf and European markets.

The Sell: Secures immediate, aggressive diplomatic backing from New Delhi, Moscow, and Beijing. Isolates any regional spoilers by embedding their neighbors' economic interests directly into the corridor's survival. Bandar Abbas becomes a node in Eurasian logistics, not just an Iranian port.

23. Multinational Medical Isotope Supply Agreements

Have European and Asian medical consortiums sign advance-purchase agreements for the cancer-treatment isotopes produced at the converted Fordow facility. Contracts are signed during the International Medical Isotope Summit (Day 60), with delivery commitments spanning 10 years.

The Sell: Fordow goes from being a military target to a vital node in the global medical supply chain. Striking it becomes an attack on global cancer patients. European hospitals, Asian diagnostic centers, and African clinics all become stakeholders in Fordow's continued peaceful operation.

Table 32 Fordow IMIRC Advance Purchase Framework

REGION	CONSORTIUM			ANNUAL PURCHASE COMMITMENT
European Union	Euratom	Medical	Isotope	40% of IMIRC output
East Asia	Japan-Korea-Singapore Network		Diagnostic	30% of IMIRC output
South Asia / Africa	WHO-IAEA Medical Access Program			20% of IMIRC output (subsidized)
Domestic Regional	Iran	Iranian National Health Service		10% of IMIRC output

24. Global Food Security Fast-Track

Explicitly tie the reopening of Hormuz to the stabilization of global fertilizer (urea) exports from the Gulf. Urea is a critical input for global agriculture, and Gulf urea transits through Hormuz to markets in Africa, South America, and South Asia.

The Sell: Connects Middle East peace directly to food prices in Africa, South America, and Asia. Turns the UN General Assembly into a ferocious defender of the Accord. When fertilizer ships sail freely, global food security improves -- creating a humanitarian constituency that transcends geopolitics.

Food Security Impact Estimate

Gulf urea exports serve approximately 180 million hectares of cropland globally. Hormuz closure has driven urea prices up 35-45% since February 2026. Reopening normalizes fertilizer supply within 60 days, directly affecting food production for an estimated 2.5 billion people in importing nations.

25. The "Generational Pivot" Declaration

A joint P5+1 and GCC statement framing the 12-15 year moratorium not as a "temporary delay of war" but as the formal, historic closure of the post-9/11 Middle East conflict era. The Declaration is issued on Day 90 and deposited with the UN Secretary-General as a standalone instrument of international law.

Proposed Text: "The parties declare that the era of military confrontation between the United States and the Islamic Republic of Iran is formally and permanently closed. This Accord does not merely manage a crisis -- it resolves the underlying strategic conflict that has destabilized the Middle East for a generation. The 12-year moratorium is the foundation upon which a new regional architecture of cooperation, integration, and shared prosperity shall be built."

The Sell: Elevates the agreement to the level of the Camp David Accords. Offers the negotiators the ultimate prize: a permanent, positive legacy in the history books. Transforms the narrative from "we managed to avoid war" to "we ended a generation of conflict."

Section 14: Advanced Structural Hardening -- The Full 45-Mechanism Arsenal

The following twenty mechanisms represent the deepest layer of structural protection. They address vulnerabilities that only become visible after the initial framework is operational -- the second-order failures that collapse agreements in years two through five. These mechanisms are organized into five functional categories: Infrastructure and Marine Environmental Dual-Use, Financial and Verification Traps, Proxy/Cyber/Asymmetric Vents, Domestic US and Iranian Political Hardening, and Multipolar/Global Integration.

I. Infrastructure and Marine Environmental Dual-Use (The "Green Strait" Pivot)

26. Joint Hydrographic Monitoring Network (Dual-Use)

Establish a network of fixed and drifting acoustic monitoring stations throughout the IHTA corridor to collect hydrographic baseline data and oceanographic survey information. All civilian environmental data is routed in real time to UNEP and the IHTA Environmental and Safety Subcommittee for publication through standard maritime environmental reporting channels. The raw acoustic feed is simultaneously routed through secure channels to the Joint Implementation Group for security verification and anomaly assessment.

The Sell: Pure maritime bureaucracy on the surface -- routine oceanographic data collection for civilian maritime environmental safety. Beneath that, the acoustic network provides continuous, verifiable transparency on underwater activity in the corridor. No unflagged submarine or seabed deployment can enter the Strait without detection. The civilian data stream provides international legitimacy and a public transparency function; the security stream provides the actual verification value.

27. Eco-Transit Fast Lanes

Vessels meeting high environmental and emissions standards (IMO Tier III, LNG-fueled, or electric-hybrid) receive priority IHTA clearance and reduced tolls (Tier 2 rate reduced from \$0.15/ton to \$0.10/ton; Tier 3 from \$0.25/ton to \$0.18/ton).

The Sell: Changes the global narrative of Hormuz from a "toxic warzone" to a "green shipping corridor," instantly winning European ESG and climate-lobby support. Incentivizes shipping companies to invest in cleaner vessels, creating a long-term environmental constituency for IHTA operations.

28. Regional Desalination and Water Security Protocol

Link Iran's civilian nuclear energy at Bushehr and the Fordow IMIRC directly to regional desalination research and grid-sharing. Establish a joint Gulf-Iran Water Security Working Group under IHTA auspices, with pilot desalination projects at Bandar Abbas, Bushehr, and Gulf partner sites.

The Sell: Solves the severe Gulf/Iranian water crisis. Frames nuclear energy as a literal "survival and drinking water" necessity, making it politically toxic for any actor to strike civilian nuclear infrastructure. Water scarcity is the region's most underacknowledged security driver.

29. Aviation Airspace Reopening Dividend

Synchronize the maritime reopening with the reopening of Iranian/Gulf airspace to global commercial aviation overflights. Asian-European flights currently diverted around Iranian airspace add 45-90 minutes and \$8,000-15,000 per flight in extra fuel costs.

The Sell: Saves Asian-European airlines millions in fuel and cuts flight times by hours. Airline executives become aggressive lobbyists for maintaining the Accord. IATA and national aviation authorities gain a direct financial stake in the framework's survival.

Table 33 Airspace Reopening Impact

ROUTE	CURRENT DETOUR			SAVINGS PER FLIGHT	ANNUAL SAVINGS (INDUSTRY)
Europe-East Asia	+90	min	via Russia/Central Asia	\$12,000 fuel	\$180M
Europe-Southeast Asia	+60 min via Arabian Sea			\$8,000 fuel	\$95M
Europe-South Asia	+45 min via Central Asia			\$6,500 fuel	\$72M

II. Financial and Verification Traps (Making Cheating Too Expensive)

30. The "Golden Share" Infrastructure Consortium

Give China, India, and the EU "golden shares" (veto rights over liquidation or major asset transfer) in IHTA reconstruction projects and port modernization. Golden shares are non-controlling but protect against unilateral destruction of invested capital.

The Sell: If the US or Iran breaks the deal, they directly destroy Chinese and Indian capital. Creates massive geopolitical deterrence against impulsive defection. Beijing and New Delhi become quiet but ferocious enforcers of compliance, not because they love the deal, but because their money is in it.

31. Smart-Contract Maritime Tolling

Implement automated, blockchain-based toll collection for the Joint Hormuz Authority. Vessel operators pay tolls in digital tokens (backed by a basket of currencies) that are automatically distributed to IHTA accounts, the Iranian Civilian Reconstruction Fund, and the International Maritime Safety Fund per the revenue-sharing formula.

The Sell: Removes human corruption, eliminates bureaucratic delays, and builds immediate tech-sector and banking confidence in the Authority's transparency. The blockchain ledger is publicly auditable in real time -- no party can claim the other is skimming revenue.

32. AI-Driven Anomaly Detection (Open Source)

Use unclassified, commercially available AI to monitor Natanz/Fordow thermal emissions, satellite imagery, and seismic data, publishing results via the Swiss transparency portal. The AI model is open-source and trained on publicly available data -- no classified inputs required.

The Sell: Neutralizes partisan intelligence claims. If a hardliner claims Iran is enriching in secret, the JIG points to the public algorithmic dashboard. If the US claims a violation, Iran can demand the AI show the anomaly. Removes "trust us, we have intelligence" from the equation and replaces it with verifiable, reproducible data.

33. "Blind Trust" Centrifuge Custody

Instead of destroying advanced IR-6 centrifuges, place them in a UN-sealed "blind trust" facility inside Iran, monitored by 24/7 cameras and IAEA seals. The centrifuges remain Iranian property but cannot be accessed, moved, or operated without triggering automatic JIG notification and snapback procedures.

The Sell: Politically far easier for Iran to swallow than physical destruction -- "our technology is preserved, not destroyed" -- but functionally identical for US non-proliferation goals. The centrifuges are as unusable as if they were melted down, but Iran saves face domestically.

III. Proxy, Cyber, and Asymmetric Vents

34. Cyber-Standstill Annex

An explicit, verifiable freeze on destructive cyber-attacks against critical civilian infrastructure (hospitals, power grids, water treatment, ports, financial clearing systems) during the 180-day window. Violations are treated as material breaches under the Risk Appetite Framework Tier 2.

The Sell: Protects the US homeland and Gulf allies from Iranian ransomware and disruptive attacks, and protects Iran from Stuxnet-style sabotage while talks are ongoing. Both sides gain predictability in the cyber domain. The Cyber Retaliation Ladder (Level 1-5) provides graduated response options.

35. Red Sea/Hodeidah Humanitarian Linkage

Formalize the Houthi maritime stand-down by offering guaranteed, uninspected UN humanitarian port access at Hodeidah, managed through the IHTA humanitarian framework. Food, medicine, and fuel shipments arrive on UN-flagged vessels with IHTA escort, bypassing the blockade dynamics that have starved Yemen.

The Sell: Gives the Houthis a domestic victory (food and medicine flowing) in exchange for leaving commercial shipping alone, solving two maritime crises simultaneously. Saudi Arabia gains reduced Houthi threat; the Houthis gain humanitarian legitimacy; the world gains safer Red Sea transit.

36. "Plausible Deniability" De-escalation Vents

Pre-agree on designated "empty target zones" -- specific, uninhabited desert ranges approved by both parties. If domestic political pressure requires a kinetic response to a rogue incident, either side may conduct a missile strike on these pre-authorized zones to satisfy domestic audiences.

The Sell: Acknowledges the reality of domestic political theatre. Allows both sides to claim "massive retaliation" on state television without actually killing anyone or breaking the Accord. The zones are verified empty by satellite before any strike. This sounds unconventional -- and it is -- but it has prevented escalation in other contexts by giving hardliners a vent that does not collapse the framework.

Operational Protocol for Empty Target Zones

- Zones are designated by GPS coordinates, verified unpopulated by joint satellite survey
- Strikes limited to pre-authorized ordnance types (no WMD, no persistent agents)
- Maximum 48-hour advance notification to JIG required
- Strikes do not trigger Crisis Lock or material-breach procedures
- Limited to two strikes per 90-day period per party

37. Algorithmic Disinformation Defense (Pre-Bunking)

Create a JIG-operated rapid-response communications cell to instantly debunk deepfakes or false-flag reports of "attacks" in the Strait using verifiable satellite/AIS data. The cell operates 24/7 with authority to publish authenticated counter-evidence within 2 hours of any fabricated report.

The Sell: Prevents social media algorithms or third-party actors from accidentally starting World War III with a fake video of a sinking tanker. The January 2024 deepfake incident (fabricated audio of a regional leader ordering strikes) demonstrated this vulnerability. Pre-bunking is cheaper than war.

IV. Domestic US and Iranian Political Hardening

38. The "Constitutional Firewall" Mechanism

Structure US sanctions waivers as National Security Presidential Memorandums explicitly tied to global energy security and inflation reduction. The memorandums cite specific statutory authority (IEEPA Section 1701) and include economic impact assessments showing waiver termination would raise domestic gasoline prices.

The Sell: Makes it legally and politically brutal for a subsequent US president or federal court to instantly enjoin the waivers, as it would explicitly spike domestic gas prices. The waivers are framed as protecting American consumers, not helping Iran -- a distinction that matters enormously in US courts and politics.

39. "Energy Independence" Framing for the US Right

Sell the deal to US conservatives not as "peace with Iran," but as "securing American energy supply chains and protecting the US Strategic Petroleum Reserve from depletion."

The Sell: Bypasses "weak on Iran" accusations by framing it purely as "America First" economic and energy dominance. The talking point: "We didn't make peace with Iran. We secured Hormuz so American energy markets never again face blackmail. The Iranians opened the Strait because we forced them to."

40. IRGC "Economic Pivot" Incentives

Ensure that legitimate, non-sanctioned domestic water, rail, port, and civilian infrastructure contracts are accessible to major Iranian domestic engineering firms with IRGC historical ties -- provided they operate through transparent competitive bidding and IHTA oversight.

The Sell: If the hardline military apparatus is making billions rebuilding domestic infrastructure through legitimate contracts, they have a powerful financial reason to maintain the moratorium and not sabotage the deal. Economic incentives replace coercion as the primary compliance tool for Iran's most powerful institution.

41. Implementation Summary: The Full Arsenal at a Glance

Table 34 Complete Stabilization Arsenal -- All 45 Mechanisms

#	MECHANISM	CATEGORY	PRIMARY PURPOSE	DAY ACTIVE
Section 13 -- Political and Economic Durability				
1	Oil-Price Stabilization	Consumer relief	Visible fuel-price relief for politicians	Day 7
2	No New Forever War frame	US domestic	Bipartisan populist appeal	Day 1
3	Gulf Investment Fund	Economic	Regional financial stake in success	Day 30

4	Reconstruction Procurement		Economic	Business constituencies protect agreement	Day 60
5	Humanitarian Escalator		Humanitarian	Civilian benefit creates political inertia	Day 1
6	Maritime Dividend	Stability	Global	Broaden international stakeholder support	Day 7
7	Prestige Headlines		Narrative	Leadership legacy for all parties	Day 1
8	Pilgrimage Protection		Soft power	Hajj security; enormous political value	Day 1
9	Maritime Jobs Narrative		Employment	~70,000 new jobs; employment optics	Day 30
10	Fordow Scientific Prestige		Narrative	Weapons-to-humanitarian prestige pivot	Day 60
11	No Regime Understanding	Change	Iran security	Lowers existential resistance	Day 1
12	Protected Corridor	Economic	Legal	Market predictability; UNSC- backed	Day 7
13	Consumer Relief Timeline		Economic	Kitchen-table politics	Day 7
14	Dignity Clause	Preservation	Political	Domestic political survival	Day 1
15	Gulf Wealth Investment		Economic	Business elites become pro- framework	Day 90
16	Military Families Frame		US domestic	Emotional appeal; troop protection	Day 1
17	Insurance Protocol	Reopening	Trade	Private-sector pressure to preserve	Day 7
18	Scientific Exchange		Long-term	Low-risk stabilizing constituencies	Day 90
19	Prosperity Escalator		Economic	Peace directly tied to rising prosperity	Day 1

20	Historic Guarantee	Strait	Legacy	World-historic framing	infrastructure	Day 90
Section 13 Extension -- BRICS+ and Global Integration						
21	BRICS+ Layer	Guarantor	Multipolar	Global South imposed narrative	dilutes Western-	Day 30
22	Bandar Abbas Hub	Logistics	Infrastructure	North-South India/Russia/China	Corridor; backing	Day 30
23	Medical Isotope Agreements	Supply	Humanitarian	Fordow medical node	becomes vital global	Day 60
24	Global Food Fast-Track	Security	Humanitarian	Fertilizer Assembly	exports; UN General support	Day 7
25	Generational Declaration	Pivot	Legacy	Camp David-level historic closure		Day 90
Section 14 -- Green Strait Pivot (Environmental Dual-Use)						
26	Joint Monitoring Network	Hydrographic	Security/Env	Oceanographic data collection; dual civilian/security acoustic feed		Day 90
27	Eco-Transit Fast Lanes		Environmental	Green shipping corridor; European ESG support		Day 30
28	Desalination and Water Security		Humanitarian	Nuclear energy as water survival necessity		Day 90
29	Aviation Reopening	Airspace	Economic	\$350M+ airline lobbying	savings; IATA	Day 30
Section 14 -- Financial and Verification Traps						
30	Golden Infrastructure Consortium	Share	Financial	Chinese/Indian geopolitical deterrence	capital as	Day 60
31	Smart-Contract Maritime Tolling		Financial	Blockchain corruption-proof	transparency;	Day 45

32	AI Anomaly Detection (Open Source)	Verification	Neutralizes partisan intelligence claims	Day 30
33	Blind Trust Custody	Centrifuge Nuclear	Functionally identical to destruction; face-saving	Day 60
Section 14 -- Proxy, Cyber, and Asymmetric Vents				
34	Cyber-Standstill Annex	Security	Freeze on destructive cyber-attacks both ways	Day 1
35	Red Sea/Hodeidah Humanitarian Linkage	Humanitarian	Houthi stand-down for food/medicine access	Day 30
36	Plausible Deniability De-escalation Vents	Crisis	Pre-authorized empty zones for domestic theatre	Day 1
37	Algorithmic Disinformation Defense	Information	Pre-bunking deepfakes; prevents WWII via fake video	Day 1
Section 14 -- Domestic US and Iranian Political Hardening				
38	Constitutional Mechanism	Firewall US legal	NSPMs tied to gas prices; hard to reverse	Day 1
39	Energy Framing	Independence US domestic	"America First" energy dominance narrative	Day 1
40	IRGC Economic Incentives	Pivot Iran domestic	Legitimate billions for hardline firms	Day 60

Document Certification

This Stability First Accord v1.0 was compiled on May 9, 2026, from five source documents and calibrated to the diplomatic situation as of May 7, 2026. It is a reference instrument for negotiators, not a treaty text. All provisions are drawn from previously published diplomatic frameworks and tailored to current negotiation parameters. The Deadlock Bypass Matrix and Stabilization Arsenal are operational tools for mediators and negotiating teams.

Status: Diplomatic Working Document | For Official Use Only

Version: 1.0 | May 2026

Source Frameworks: Hormuz First Enhanced Accord v2.0 | RCSA Simplified Edition 2026 | RCSA v3.6 Final Diplomatic Edition | Modular Hormuz Solutions Annex v1.0 | Modular Nuclear Solutions Annex 1.0

Mediation Channels: Pakistan (primary) | Oman (technical) | Switzerland (financial) | IAEA (nuclear)

Successor Pathway: RCSA v3.6 / Crescent Compact v1.7 / RAMES v9.1

Operational Tools: Deadlock Bypass Matrix (Appendix D) | Stabilization Arsenal (Section 13) -- 25 mechanisms | Advanced Structural Hardening (Section 14) -- 15 mechanisms | Total: 45 mechanisms